



Agencies told they can ignore Musk email

Employees won't be fired for not saying what they did over the past week

BY EMILY DAVIES,
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JEFF STEIN
AND LISA REIN

The Trump administration has told federal agency leaders that they can ignore the public decree from Elon Musk to effectively fire employees who do not send in bullet-point summaries of their work last week, according to three people familiar with the matter, a break with the billionaire who has exerted significant power to slash the 2.3-million-person federal workforce.

The Office of Personnel Management, a federal agency that functions as the government's HR department, delivered the news to agency chief human capital officers on a call Monday, according to one of the people, an agency official on the call, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss internal conversations.

Another person briefed on the call said that OPM is also looking at weekly reporting for government departments. But the person said that OPM was unsure what to do with the emails of employees who responded so far and had "no plans" to analyze

SEE WORKERS ON A4

Payments delayed: USDA staffers struggle with funding freeze. **A3**

Virginia: Youngkin says new state website will aid fired workers. **B1**

DOGE cuts workers using tech playbook

Musk deploys disruptive management style he adopted in Silicon Valley

BY HANNAH NATANSON,
ELIZABETH DWOSKIN,
GERRIT DE VYNCK
AND FAIZ SIDDIQUI

U.S. DOGE Service personnel come in hot. Striding into federal departments in casual clothes and muppy haircuts, they demand access to employment and funding databases. Federal workers who refuse can find themselves on a tense phone call with DOGE head Elon Musk or one of his senior aides.

Once DOGE crews gain access to IT systems, they use tech tools to quickly identify programs to cut and people to fire. In some cases, they have used artificial intelligence software to comb through federal databases for targets.

This account of the Department of Government Efficiency's cut-first-ask-questions-later approach is based on meeting records obtained by The Washington Post and conversations with eight people familiar with the group's work or Musk's goals and philosophy. All spoke on the condition of anonymity to avoid retaliation or to discuss private information.

SEE DOGE ON A7

U.S. votes against condemning Russia



ROMAN PILIPEY/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Women pay tribute at a memorial for fallen Ukrainian and foreign fighters at Kyiv's Independence Square on Monday, which marked the third anniversary of Russia's invasion. A U.N. General Assembly resolution condemning Russian aggression passed without U.S. support.

Stricter FAA regulations disrupt flights at National

BY IAN DUNCAN
AND LORI ARATANI

Airline passengers have experienced serious disruptions at Washington's Reagan National Airport because of new rules that trigger runway closures when President Donald Trump flies to and from the White House aboard his helicopter, according to people aware of the restrictions, flight tracking data and federal records.

The stricter requirements — imposed by the Federal Aviation Administration after the midair collision of an Army helicopter and American Airlines passenger jet last month that killed 67 peo-

After midair collision, runways close when Marine One is nearby

ple — have forced dozens of airliners bound for National to circle in holding patterns or divert to other airports including Dulles International, Baltimore-Washington International Marshall and Richmond International.

American Airlines pilots have been told they might need to carry more fuel to account for potential delays when they are flying into

National, according to a company memo obtained by The Washington Post.

Passengers have noticed the spate of disruptions, raising questions on social media in recent days. "Anyone know what's going on with air traffic?" one user posted on a Reddit page focused on the Washington area Saturday, when Trump traveled by Marine One to a political conference in the Maryland suburbs. The user said their spouse's pilot told passengers there was "VIP movement in the DC airspace and they don't want any commercial aircraft there right now."

The FAA has rolled out restric-

tions in the airspace around National in the weeks after the Jan. 29 crash, seeking to reduce the chance of further encounters between helicopters and airliners.

In the immediate aftermath, the agency ended helicopter flights in a designated area along the Potomac River, with exceptions for critical flights such as law enforcement and presidential flights on Marine One.

On Feb. 13, an additional FAA safety measure went into place affecting a broader area: air traffic

SEE DCA ON A19

Air traffic control: Plan for new academy failed in Congress. **A20**

ROBERTA FLACK 1937-2025

Spellbinding singer with a string of 1970s hits

Onetime D.C. teacher found fame and acclaim with quiet, emotionally searching recordings

BY MATT SCHUDEL

Roberta Flack, a classically trained pianist who taught in the D.C. school system before launching a singing career that made her one of the most popular performers of the 1970s, with such No. 1 hits as "The First Time Ever I Saw Your Face" and "Killing Me Softly With His Song," died Feb. 24 in Manhattan. She was 88.

The cause was complications from amyotrophic lateral sclerosis, sometimes called Lou Gehrig's disease, said her publicist Elaine Schock.

Ms. Flack taught music and accompanied other vocalists on piano before she was coaxed into singing Christmas carols while appearing at a Washington nightclub in the 1960s. She eventually decided to concentrate on a music career, and her quiet, emotionally searching style soon won a growing number of fans.

By the end of her life, Ms. Flack had influenced generations of younger singers, including Whitney Houston, Anita Baker, Sade and Lady Gaga.

Ms. Flack's 1969 debut album, "First Take," contained "The First Time Ever I Saw Your Face," which she had taught years earlier to some of her choral students



1984 PHOTO BY DAVID REDFERN/REDFERNS

Roberta Flack was the first person to win back-to-back Grammys for record of the year, for "The First Time Ever I Saw Your Face" and "Killing Me Softly With His Song."

at Washington's Banneker Junior High (now a high school). She released two more albums, "Chapter Two" and "Quiet Fire," in 1970 and 1971, respectively, and was seemingly content with a niche following.

When Clint Eastwood was preparing to direct "Play Misty for Me," his moody 1971 thriller about a DJ pursued by a stalker, he heard "The First Time Ever I Saw Your Face" on the radio. Eastwood called Ms. Flack and asked if he could use the song for a key scene in the film.

"He was so sincere," Ms. Flack later told Britain's Daily Telegraph newspaper, and "he wanted it just how it sounds. 'Isn't it too slow?' I asked. He replied, 'No, just like that, all of it.' And he played all five minutes and 22 seconds of it. I thought, if he's willing to do that, I must be doing something right."

The film's success led Ms. Flack's record label, Atlantic, to release "First Time" as a single — shortened by about a minute. The song, written by British folk singer Ewan MacColl in 1957, had been recorded several times before, but it was Ms. Flack's version that became a sensation.

"First Time" spent six weeks at

SEE FLACK ON A16

Podcaster who bashed FBI will be its deputy leader

BY PERRY STEIN,
JEREMY ROEBUCK,
JONATHAN BARAN
AND CLARA ENCE MORSE

FBI Director Kash Patel has offered the public two different visions for the nation's powerful law enforcement agency.

During his confirmation hearing, Patel assured senators that "there will be no politicization at the FBI" and that he respects the agents who work at the bureau. Under his watch, FBI personnel would not be fired based on the cases they were assigned, Patel testified.

But in his 2023 book and in public appearances, Patel has portrayed a dramatically different vision. He derided FBI agents as people who can't be trusted and called for retribution against his and President Donald Trump's perceived enemies.

On Sunday, Patel tapped as his deputy director Dan Bongino — a bombastic podcast host who has never worked at the FBI and has spent years pushing conspiracy theories about the bureau and the "deep state" he says has

SEE FBI ON A4

IN THE NEWS

Special prayers Pope Francis showed "slight improvement" as the Vatican holds nightly rosary recitations for his health. **A15**

Clint Hill dies at 93 The Secret Service agent leaped onto John F. Kennedy's limousine to try to shield the president after he was shot. The killing haunted him for years. **B1**

THE NATION

The Supreme Court won't hear a challenge to buffer zones around abortion clinics. **A2**
Jury selection began in the trial of a man accused of a mass killing at an Illinois parade. **A9**

THE WORLD

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Germany's probable next chancellor called for European independence from the U.S. **A17**

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Starbucks said it will lay off 1,100 corporate employees as part of its attempt to turn around its business. **A19**

THE REGION

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Gov. Wes Moore sharpened his criticism of the Trump administration after months of careful maneuvering. **B1**

STYLE

MSNBC canceled Joy Reid's program and will move Jen Psaki to a more prominent time slot starting in April. **C1**

HEALTH & SCIENCE

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